

Steady growth driven by PCB and IC substrate

Better product mix to underpin margin expansion

Action: Maintain Buy but raise TP to CNY518, implying 42.3% upside

Shennan Circuits (SCC) issued a strong 1H26 profit alert on 14 July, setting a net profit guidance of CNY2.1bn-2.3bn (+54.4%-69.1% y-y) that translates to CNY1.25-1.45bn (+44%-67% y-y or +47%-71% q-q) in 2Q26F. We think the solid 2Q26F performance was mainly driven by strong demand for AI PCB and BT-substrate, from server, switch, optical transceiver and memory customers, in our view. Moreover, we think the company has significant room to grow in the high-end product segment (i.e., ABF-substrate), driven by rising demand from domestic AI chip and memory customers. We raise FY26-28F revenue forecasts by 3.2%-10.7% to reflect stronger demand, and we raise FY26-28F earnings forecasts by 9.9%-18.7%, considering its better product mix and improved profitability from the substrate segment. We maintain our Buy rating, and raise TP to CNY518 (from CNY391), based on 43x FY27F EPS of CNY12.05 (previously 37x), in line with an FY26-28F earnings CAGR of 43%. The stock is currently trading at 30x FY27F EPS.

PCB: high-end optical transceivers, network switch and AI servers are key drivers and differentiate company from peers

We believe SCC is one of the key suppliers of optical transceivers in China. Its strong relationship with domestic customers will enable it to benefit from the 800G / 1.6T transceiver upgrade cycle in 2026-2027F, in our view. Besides, we think SCC has strong execution power in the AI server and switch segments, empowering it to become a key beneficiary in China's accelerated AI investment cycle. Although SCC is constrained by limited capacity, management already started new projects earlier this year (targeting to invest CNY4.6bn in Wuxi). We estimate a 40% revenue CAGR in FY26F-28F for the PCB segment, contributing 69% of total revenue in FY28F.

IC substrate: BT-substrate enjoys solid demand but pricing pressure exists, ABF-substrate still in early commercialization stage with strong potential in China

SCC's BT substrate enjoys solid demand from memory customers, which has enabled it to record higher utilization rates and margin improvement. Management notes there is potential room to raise prices due to upstream material price hikes. On ABF-substrate, the company can produce 20+ layer products, according to management, adding that it is on track to narrow its loss margin in this segment. We expect the IC substrate segment to deliver a 38% revenue CAGR over FY26F-28F, contributing 19% of total revenue in FY28F.

Year-end 31 Dec	FY25		FY26F		FY27F		FY28F	
Currency (CNY)	Actual	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New	
Revenue (mn)	23,647	31,736	32,744	42,274	45,128	54,335	60,173	
Reported net profit (mn)	3,276	4,957	5,448	7,047	8,037	9,325	11,069	
Normalised net profit (mn)	3,276	4,957	5,448	7,047	8,037	9,325	11,069	
FD normalised EPS	6.39	7.43	8.17	10.57	12.05	13.99	16.60	
FD norm. EPS growth (%)	74.5	16.4	27.9	42.2	47.5	32.3	37.7	
FD normalised P/E (x)	57.0	—	44.5	—	30.2	—	21.9	
EV/EBITDA (x)	48.9	—	31.1	—	22.4	—	16.7	
Price/book (x)	14.2	—	11.6	—	9.2	—	7.3	
Dividend yield (%)	0.7	—	1.1	—	1.7	—	2.3	
ROE (%)	20.6	26.4	28.6	31.0	34.0	33.4	37.1	
Net debt/equity (%)	14.6	5.2	4.2	net cash	net cash	net cash	net cash	

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Rating Remains **Buy**

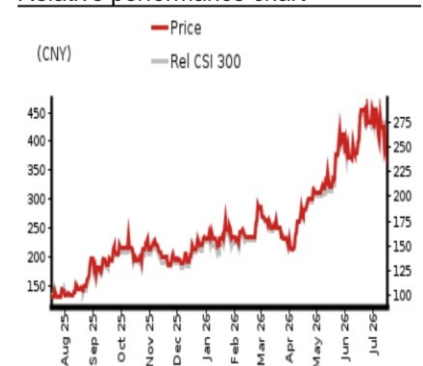
Target price Increased from CNY 391.00 **CNY 518.00**

Closing price 16 July 2026 **CNY 364.00**

Implied upside **+42.3%**

Market Cap (USD mn) 36,637.6
ADT (USD mn) 766.0

Relative performance chart



Source: LSEG, Nomura

Research Analysts

China Technology

Bing Duan - NIHK

bing.duan1@nomura.com
+852 2252 2141

Anne Lee, CFA - NITB

anne.lee@nomura.com
+886(2) 21769966

Key data on Shennan Circuits

Performance

(%)	1M	3M	12M		
Absolute (CNY)	-9.9	34.7	194.7	M cap (USDmn)	36,637.6
Absolute (USD)	-10.0	35.7	212.5	Free float (%)	35.8
Rel to CSI 300	-6.1	35.6	177.4	3-mth ADT (USDmn)	766.0

Income statement (CNYmn)

Year-end 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
Revenue	17,907	23,647	32,744	45,128	60,173
Cost of goods sold	-13,460	-16,951	-22,449	-30,334	-40,027
Gross profit	4,447	6,696	10,295	14,794	20,146
SG&A	-2,432	-3,163	-4,379	-6,036	-8,048
Employee share expense					
Operating profit	2,015	3,533	5,916	8,758	12,098
EBITDA	3,435	5,123	7,992	10,969	14,390
Depreciation	-1,420	-1,590	-2,076	-2,211	-2,292
Amortisation					
EBIT	2,015	3,533	5,916	8,758	12,098
Net interest expense	-47	-49	-84	-138	-214
Associates & JCEs					
Other income	55	139	193	266	354
Earnings before tax	2,023	3,624	6,025	8,886	12,238
Income tax	-145	-345	-574	-847	-1,166
Net profit after tax	1,879	3,279	5,451	8,039	11,072
Minority interests	-1	-3	-3	-3	-3
Other items					
Preferred dividends					
Normalised NPAT	1,878	3,276	5,448	8,037	11,069
Extraordinary items					
Reported NPAT	1,878	3,276	5,448	8,037	11,069
Dividends	-769	-1,635	-2,719	-4,011	-5,524
Transfer to reserves	1,108	1,641	2,729	4,026	5,545

Valuations and ratios

Reported P/E (x)	99.4	57.0	44.5	30.2	21.9
Normalised P/E (x)	99.4	57.0	44.5	30.2	21.9
FD normalised P/E (x)	99.4	57.0	44.5	30.2	21.9
Dividend yield (%)	0.4	0.7	1.1	1.7	2.3
Price/cashflow (x)	62.6	48.6	36.1	26.8	20.0
Price/book (x)	12.8	14.2	11.6	9.2	7.3
EV/EBITDA (x)	72.7	48.9	31.1	22.4	16.7
EV/EBIT (x)	123.9	70.9	42.1	28.1	19.9
Gross margin (%)	24.8	28.3	31.4	32.8	33.5
EBITDA margin (%)	19.2	21.7	24.4	24.3	23.9
EBIT margin (%)	11.3	14.9	18.1	19.4	20.1
Net margin (%)	10.5	13.9	16.6	17.8	18.4
Effective tax rate (%)	7.1	9.5	9.5	9.5	9.5
Dividend payout (%)	41.0	49.9	49.9	49.9	49.9
ROE (%)	13.5	20.6	28.6	34.0	37.1
ROA (pretax %)	8.9	13.2	18.5	23.2	27.4
Growth (%)					
Revenue	32.4	32.1	38.5	37.8	33.3
EBITDA	48.7	49.1	56.0	37.3	31.2
Normalised EPS	34.3	74.5	27.9	47.5	37.7
Normalised FDEPS	34.3	74.5	27.9	47.5	37.7

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Cashflow statement (CNYmn)

Year-end 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
EBITDA	3,435	5,123	7,992	10,969	14,390
Change in working capital	-451	-935	-873	-1,261	-1,285
Other operating cashflow	-2	-350	-390	-644	-951
Cashflow from operations	2,982	3,838	6,729	9,064	12,154
Capital expenditure	-2,526	-3,765	-3,465	-3,165	-2,865
Free cashflow	456	73	3,264	5,899	9,289
Reduction in investments	0				
Net acquisitions					
Dec in other LT assets	0				
Inc in other LT liabilities	2	109	0	0	0
Adjustments	600	-99	0	0	0
CF after investing acts	1,057	83	3,264	5,899	9,289
Cash dividends	-543	-846	-1,635	-2,719	-4,011
Equity issue	31	0	0	0	0
Debt issue	133	207	121	0	0
Convertible debt issue					
Others	22	1	0	0	0
CF from financial acts	-357	-638	-1,514	-2,719	-4,011
Net cashflow	701	-555	1,750	3,180	5,278
Beginning cash	853	1,553	998	2,748	5,928
Ending cash	1,554	998	2,748	5,928	11,206
Ending net debt	1,740	2,511	882	-2,298	-7,576

Balance sheet (CNYmn)

As at 31 Dec	FY24	FY25	FY26F	FY27F	FY28F
Cash & equivalents	1,553	998	2,748	5,928	11,206
Marketable securities					
Accounts receivable	4,369	5,919	8,327	11,307	14,872
Inventories	3,395	5,140	6,163	9,110	11,044
Other current assets	1,537	1,597	1,597	1,597	1,597
Total current assets	10,854	13,654	18,835	27,941	38,719
LT investments					
Fixed assets	13,283	15,190	16,579	17,533	18,107
Goodwill	585	639	611	584	557
Other intangible assets	579	1,100	1,050	999	948
Other LT assets					
Total assets	25,302	30,583	37,074	47,058	58,331
Short-term debt	716	831	951	951	951
Accounts payable	6,525	9,004	11,562	16,227	20,442
Other current liabilities	248	190	190	190	190
Total current liabilities	7,489	10,024	12,703	17,368	21,583
Long-term debt	2,577	2,679	2,679	2,679	2,679
Convertible debt					
Other LT liabilities	590	699	699	699	699
Total liabilities	10,656	13,402	16,081	20,746	24,961
Minority interest	29	31	31	31	31
Preferred stock					
Common stock	513	667	667	667	667
Retained earnings	14,104	16,483	20,296	25,613	32,672
Proposed dividends					
Other equity and reserves					
Total shareholders' equity	14,617	17,149	20,962	26,280	33,339
Total equity & liabilities	25,302	30,583	37,074	47,058	58,331
Liquidity (x)					
Current ratio	1.45	1.36	1.48	1.61	1.79
Interest cover	43.1	72.5	70.5	63.4	56.5

Leverage

Net debt/EBITDA (x)	0.51	0.49	0.11	net cash	net cash
Net debt/equity (%)	11.9	14.6	4.2	net cash	net cash

Per share

Reported EPS (CNY)	3.66	6.39	8.17	12.05	16.60
Norm EPS (CNY)	3.66	6.39	8.17	12.05	16.60
FD norm EPS (CNY)	3.66	6.39	8.17	12.05	16.60
BVPS (CNY)	28.50	25.72	31.44	39.42	50.00
DPS (CNY)	1.50	2.45	4.08	6.02	8.29

Activity (days)

Days receivable	79.2	79.4	79.4	79.4	79.6
Days inventory	82.7	91.9	91.9	91.9	92.1
Days payable	162.5	167.2	167.2	167.2	167.6
Cash cycle	-0.6	4.1	4.1	4.1	4.1

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Company profile

Shennan Circuits Co Ltd (SCC) is one of the leading PCB (Printed Circuit Board) manufacturer headquartered in Shenzhen, Guangdong China. Main business of SCC include PCB, IC substrate, and PCB assembly.

Valuation Methodology

Our target price of CNY518.00 is based on 43x 2027F EPS of CNY12.05, in line with FY26-28F earnings CAGR of 43%. The benchmark index is CSI300.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price

Downside risks include: 1) delay in AI infra investment or slower-than-expected capacity expansion for AI PCB; 2) further sanctions on the telecom value chain companies in China by the US; and 3) intensified competition in the PCB market in China.

ESG

SCC is a leading telecom equipment producer, which shares social responsibility by offering infrastructure products for telecom network. The telecom equipment manufacturing requires land, equipment and other materials which may have impacts to environment, while factory automation may help to improve environmental scores. Corporate governance needs improvement in terms of shareholder return, etc.

Earnings forecast revisions

We raise FY26-28F revenue forecasts by 3.2%-10.7% to reflect stronger demand from both AI PCB and IC substrate markets. Thanks to better exposure to high-end AI related products, our GPM forecasts are 3.5%-11.3% higher than our previous estimates. As a result, we raise FY26-28F earnings forecasts by 9.9-18.7%.

Fig. 1: Shennan Circuits - earnings forecast revisions

(CNY mn)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026F	2027F	2028F	2026F	2027F	2028F	2026F	2027F	2028F
	A	A	A	A	(NOM)	(NOM)	(NOM)	(OLD)	(OLD)	(OLD)	% diff	% diff	% diff
Turnover	13,992	13,526	17,907	23,647	32,744	45,128	60,173	31,736	42,274	54,335	3.2%	6.8%	10.7%
% chg yoy	0%	-3%	32%	32%	38%	38%	33%	34%	33%	29%			
COGS	(10,422)	(10,357)	(13,460)	(16,951)	(22,449)	(30,334)	(40,027)	(22,115)	(28,947)	(36,884)	1.5%	4.8%	8.5%
Gross Profit	3,571	3,170	4,447	6,696	10,295	14,794	20,146	9,621	13,327	17,451	7.0%	11.0%	15.4%
OPEX	(1,848)	(1,772)	(2,419)	(3,061)	(4,741)	(6,452)	(8,540)	(4,604)	(6,062)	(7,739)	3.0%	6.4%	10.4%
Operating Income	1,723	1,398	2,028	3,635	5,554	8,342	11,606	5,017	7,265	9,712	10.7%	14.8%	19.5%
% chg yoy	7%	-19%	45%	79%	53%	50%	39%	38%	45%	34%			
Pretax income	1,720	1,398	2,023	3,624	6,025	8,886	12,238	5,482	7,793	10,310	9.9%	14.0%	18.7%
% chg yoy	7%	-19%	45%	79%	66%	47%	38%	51%	42%	32%			
Tax	(80)	(1)	(145)	(345)	(574)	(847)	(1,166)	(522)	(743)	(982)			
Profit to shareholders	1,640	1,398	1,878	3,276	5,448	8,037	11,069	4,957	7,047	9,325	9.9%	14.0%	18.7%
% chg yoy	11%	-15%	34%	74%	66%	48%	38%	51%	42%	32%			
Ratio Analysis													
GPM	25.5%	23.4%	24.8%	28.3%	31.4%	32.8%	33.5%	30.3%	31.5%	32.1%	1.1pp	1.3pp	1.4pp
OPEX	13.2%	13.1%	13.5%	12.9%	14.5%	14.3%	14.2%	14.5%	14.3%	14.2%	0.0pp	0.0pp	0.0pp
OPM	12.3%	10.3%	11.3%	15.4%	17.0%	18.5%	19.3%	15.8%	17.2%	17.9%	1.2pp	1.3pp	1.4pp
NPM	11.7%	10.3%	10.5%	13.9%	16.6%	17.8%	18.4%	15.6%	16.7%	17.2%	1.0pp	1.1pp	1.2pp

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Fig. 2: Shennan Circuits - earnings forecast revisions for segment

(CNY mn)	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026F	2027F	2028F	2026F	2027F	2028F	2026F	2027F	2028F
	A	A	A	A	(NOM)	(NOM)	(NOM)	(OLD)	(OLD)	(OLD)	% diff	% diff	% diff
Revenue by segment													
PCB	8,825	8,073	10,494	14,359	21,085	30,328	41,500	20,367	28,277	37,279	3.5%	7.3%	11.3%
y-y growth	1%	-9%	30%	37%	47%	44%	37%	42%	39%	32%			
% in total	65%	62%	62%	64%	64%	67%	69%	64%	67%	69%			
IC substrate	2,520	2,306	3,171	4,148	5,923	8,340	11,326	5,633	7,537	9,707	5.2%	10.7%	16.7%
y-y growth	4%	-8%	37%	31%	43%	41%	36%	36%	34%	29%			
% in total	19%	18%	19%	19%	18%	18%	19%	18%	18%	18%			
PCB assembly	1,744	2,119	2,823	3,075	3,411	3,784	4,198	3,411	3,784	4,198	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%
y-y growth	-10%	21%	33%	9%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%	11%			
% in total	13%	16%	17%	14%	10%	8%	7%	11%	9%	8%			
GPM													
PCB	28.1%	26.6%	31.6%	35.5%	37.5%	38.0%	38.1%	36.5%	37.0%	37.1%	1.0pp	1.0pp	1.0pp
IC substrate	27.0%	23.9%	18.1%	22.6%	30.6%	31.6%	32.1%	28.6%	29.6%	30.1%	2.0pp	2.0pp	2.0pp
PCB assembly	13.1%	14.7%	14.4%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	0.0pp	0.0pp	0.0pp

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Fig. 3: Shennan Circuits - quarterly earnings forecasts

(CNY mn)	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26F	3Q26F	4Q26F
	A	A	A	A	A	A	A	A	A	(NOM)	(NOM)	(NOM)
Turnover	3,961	4,360	4,728	4,858	4,783	5,671	6,301	6,893	6,596	7,585	8,723	9,841
% chg yoy	42%	34%	38%	20%	21%	30%	33%	42%	38%	87%	120%	126%
COGS	(2,963)	(3,178)	(3,528)	(3,792)	(3,600)	(4,106)	(4,323)	(4,922)	(4,672)	(5,162)	(5,980)	(6,635)
Gross Profit	998	1,182	1,201	1,066	1,183	1,564	1,978	1,971	1,924	2,423	2,743	3,206
OPEX	(590)	(515)	(675)	(639)	(656)	(583)	(915)	(907)	(981)	(1,174)	(1,176)	(1,410)
Operating Income	408	668	526	427	527	981	1,063	1,064	943	1,249	1,567	1,795
% chg yoy	94%	179%	20%	-16%	29%	47%	102%	149%	79%	144%	284%	169%
Pretax income	407	668	525	424	523	976	1,060	1,065	941	1,433	1,605	2,046
% chg yoy	95%	177%	20%	-17%	29%	46%	102%	151%	80%	181%	295%	206%
Tax	(28)	(60)	(25)	(33)	(31)	(106)	(93)	(114)	(89)	(137)	(153)	(195)
Profit to shareholders	380	608	501	390	491	869	966	950	850	1,296	1,451	1,850
% chg yoy	84%	127%	15%	-21%	29%	43%	93%	144%	73%	165%	282%	204%
Ratio Analysis												
GPM	25.2%	27.1%	25.4%	22.0%	24.7%	27.6%	31.4%	28.6%	29.2%	31.9%	31.4%	32.6%
OPEX	14.9%	11.8%	14.3%	13.2%	13.7%	10.3%	14.5%	13.2%	14.9%	15.5%	13.5%	14.3%
OPM	10.3%	15.3%	11.1%	8.8%	11.0%	17.3%	16.9%	15.4%	14.3%	16.5%	18.0%	18.2%
NPM	9.6%	13.9%	10.6%	8.0%	10.3%	15.3%	15.3%	13.8%	12.9%	17.1%	16.6%	18.8%

Source: Company data, Nomura estimates

Our FY26-28F revenue / earnings forecasts are 4-20% / 4-13% higher than WIND consensus, as we are more positive on SCC's AI exposure and margin expansion, driven by a better product mix.

Fig. 4: Shennan Circuits - Nomura vs consensus estimates

CNY mn	2025	2026F			2027F			2028F		
		(NOM)	(CON)	diff	(NOM)	(CON)	diff	(NOM)	(CON)	diff
Revenue	23,647	32,744	31,482	4%	45,128	39,945	13%	60,173	50,146	20%
Pretax Profit	3,624	6,025	5,970	1%	8,886	8,202	8%	12,238	10,842	13%
Net Profit	3,276	5,448	5,371	1%	8,037	7,471	8%	11,069	9,969	11%
EPS	4.91	8.17	7.89	4%	12.05	10.97	10%	16.60	14.64	13%

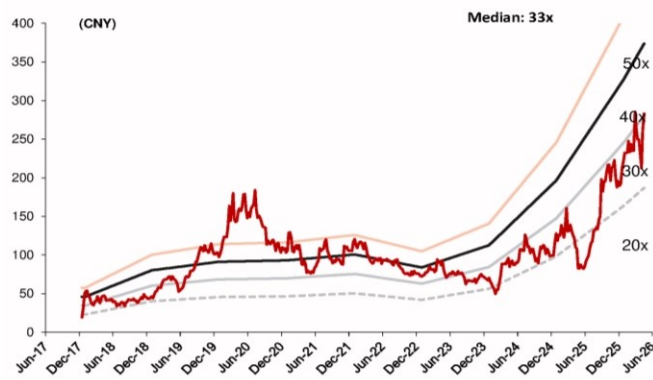
Source: Company data, WIND, Nomura estimates

Valuation and risks

Our target price of CNY518.00 is based on 43x 2027F EPS of CNY12.05, corresponding to our estimated FY26-28F earnings CAGR of 43%. The benchmark index is CSI300.

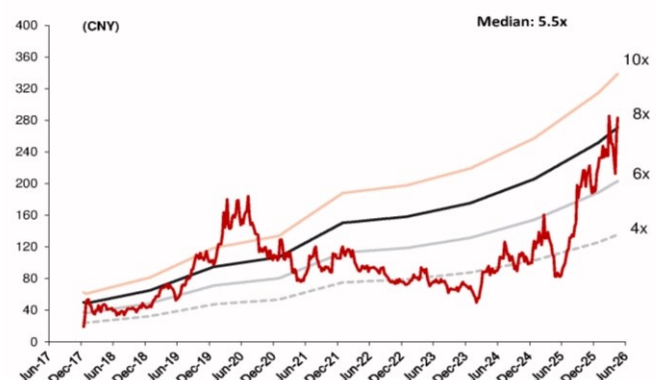
Downside risks include: 1) delay in AI infra investment or slower-than-expected capacity expansion for AI PCB; 2) further sanctions on the telecom value chain companies in China by the US; and 3) intensified competition in the PCB market in China.

Fig. 5: Shennan Circuits - 12-month forward P/E band



Source: Company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P., Nomura estimates

Fig. 6: Shennan Circuits - 12-month forward P/B band



Source: Company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P., Nomura estimates

Appendix A-1

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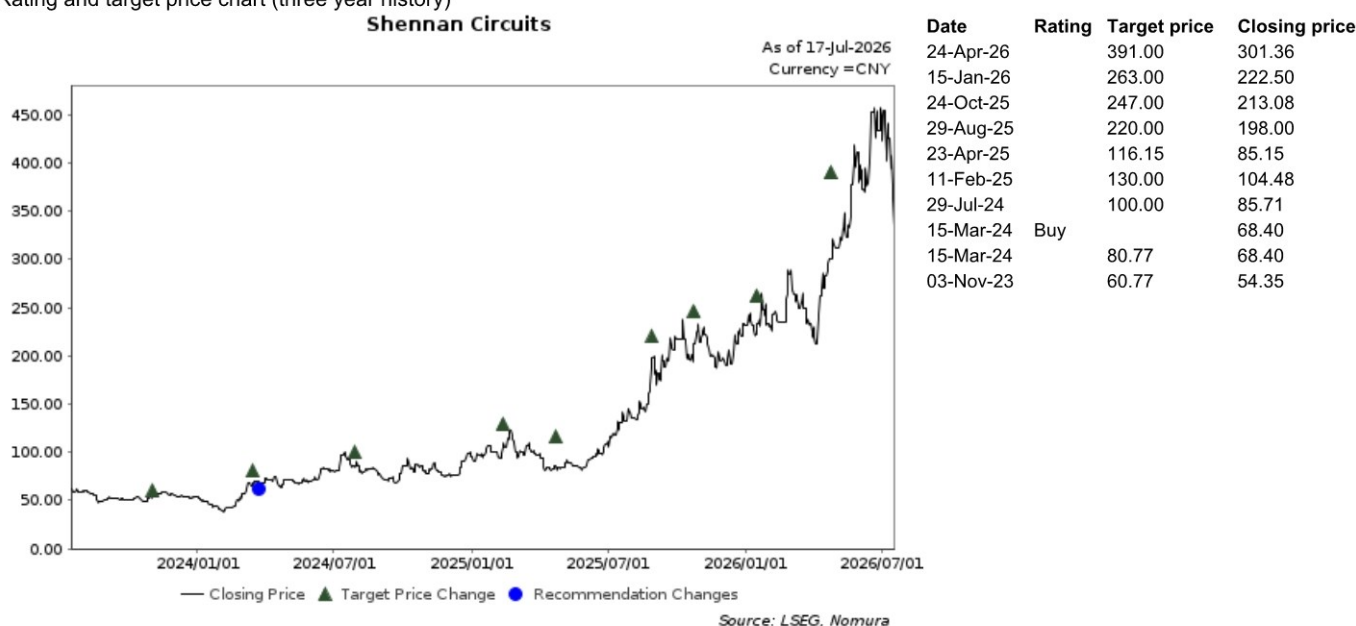
Materially mentioned issuers

Issuer	Ticker	Price	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Shennan Circuits	002916 CH	CNY 364.00	16-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	

Shennan Circuits (002916 CH)

CNY 364.00 (16-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of CNY518.00 is based on 43x 2027F EPS of CNY12.05, in line with FY26-28F earnings CAGR of 43%. The benchmark index is CSI300.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include: 1) delay in AI infra investment or slower-than-expected capacity expansion for AI PCB; 2) further sanctions on the telecom value chain companies in China by the US; and 3) intensified competition in the PCB market in China.

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As at 30 June 2026.

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